

KF Reading Guide

Chapter 3: *The Tyranny of the Should*¹

1. On what two worlds do neurotics focus in trying to actualize their idealized self? (64.1–2)
 - A.
 - B.
2. Of what do the inner dictates comprise? (65.2)
3. What necessity do neurotics feel and what is their conviction? (65.4).
4. What are the two characteristics of the drive for actualization? (66.1–3).
 - A.
 - B.
5. To neurotics, recognizing their neurotic claims seems to be the equivalent of what? (67.1)
6. The inner dictates operate with supreme disregard for what? (67.2)
7. What is the logic behind the neurotic's refusal to examine existing conditions? (68.2)
8. What is a matter-of-fact attitude toward the past? (69.2)
9. In view of our neurotic difficulties at the time of our "failures", what might we recognize? (69.3).
10. In what two ways does the neurotic try to overcome present shortcomings? (70.2-3).
 - A.
 - B.
11. Using willpower is fine if the person is also showing what? (70.4)

12. If the neurotic is using only willpower to overcome disturbances and difficulties, what is sure to happen? (70.4–71.1)
13. Do most neurotic disturbances respond to strenuous efforts at control? (71.2)
14. Why is depression so much more painful for neurotics? (71.2)
15. On whom had Horney's client projected her expectation of herself? (71.2)
16. At what do the inner dictates aim? (72.2)
17. What happens when inner demands are externalized? (72.2)
18. What do the "shoulds" lack? (72.3)
19. Even moral shoulds are permeated by what spirit? (73.1)
20. In your opinion, is it moral to be dishonest in order to look good?
21. Compare the characteristics of coercive shoulds with genuine standards. Refer to the book and draw on your own experience. (72.5–74.1)

Coercive Should (inner dictates)

- Immediate, absolute perfection
- Weakens us; enslaving
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-
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Genuine Standards

- Real change – what I am is relevant and important
- Strengthens us with congruence
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22. Why does the reaction of anxiety escape attention? (74.3)
23. What can throw us out of gear? (75.2)
24. How are the inner dictates primarily determined? (76.1)
25. What is crucial for the expansive type? (76.2)
26. What is sufficient for expansive types? (76.3)
27. What solves all problems for the self-effacing type? (76.4)
28. What is the foremost conscious experience for the self-effacing type? (77.1)
29. What idea appeals more than anything else to the resigned type? (77.3)
30. Of the three neurotic types, resigned types are most prone to rebel against what? (77.3)
31. Can a person who usually complies with their shoulds have a rebellious phase? (77.5)
32. Where does a great deal of the process of grappling with shoulds take place? (78.2)
33. On whom do neurotics primarily impose their standards and make relentless demands for perfection?
(78.2)
34. Neurotics may believe that their expectations of themselves are coming from whom? (78.3)
35. In what two ways do neurotics respond to expectations? (79.1)
 - A.
 - B.

36. Overreaction to requests can lead us to recognize what? (79.2)
37. What feeling do the shoulds produce? (81.2)
38. To what does the externalization of shoulds always contribute? (81.3)
39. In relationships, what is the most general disturbance caused by externalized shoulds? (81.3)
40. For what do neurotics hate themselves? (81.3)
41. What do the shoulds further impair? (81.4)
42. What are we accustomed to think that we cannot control? (82.1)
43. What does the “magic wand” of our imagination do for us? (82.1)
44. What can we expect when pseudo-feelings are shaken? (82.2)
45. What was the patient able to see for the first time? (82.4)
46. The ability to create make-believe feelings is most striking in which kind of people? (83.2)
47. What are the characteristics of made-to-order feelings? (83.2-3)
- A.
 - B.
 - C.
 - D.
 - E.
48. What other feelings can be exaggerated? (83.4)

49. When inner commands are contradictory, what results? (84.2)

F.

G.

H.

50. Why are neurotics unable to consider relinquishing their shoulds? (84.4)

51. What makes the enormous coercive power of the shoulds a “regime of terror”? (85.2)

¹ This reading guide refers to the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle Toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney, published by W.W. Norton and Company Inc. New York.